

Western Himalayan Temperate Forest

Location Nepal and far northern Pakistan and India, on the southern slopes of the western Himalayas

Comprising broadleaf forest at an altitude of about 2,000–8,500 ft (600–2,600 m) and subalpine conifer forest at higher elevations up to some 12,500 ft (3,800 m), this biome is more fragmented than its eastern Himalayan counterpart and receives less moisture from the Bay of Bengal monsoon. Birch and rhododendron are common broadleaf trees, and conifers such as blue pine, spruce, yew, and fir are plentiful. One area of forest, the Palas Valley, has the richest flora in Pakistan. The forest is home to endangered mammals, including the Himalayan tahr, and birds such as the western tragopan and Himalayan monal.

▼ THE SOUTHWESTERN GHATS MOIST FOREST

The Mudumalai Forest

Location The Western Ghats mountains in Tamil Nadu, southern India

Up to 80 tigers live in the protected section of this forest, which is a 120-square-mile (320-square-km) national park. Other endangered species include the Indian leopard, sloth bear, and gaur. More than 200 bird species live here, including the endemic black-and-orange flycatcher. The forest can be divided into tropical moist deciduous, tropical dry deciduous, and tropical dry thorn forest—primarily reflecting differences in rainfall.

Southwestern Ghats Moist Forest

Location The Western Ghats mountains in southwest India

This ecoregion is one of extremely rich biodiversity, including more

than 4,000 types of flowering plants. Many animals are endemic to these tropical and subtropical moist broadleaf forests, including lion-tailed macaque, Nilgiri tahr, 90 species of reptiles, and 85 species of amphibians. This forest grows at elevations of 820–3,300 ft (250–1,000 m), between the Malabar coast moist forest below and montane forest at higher altitudes. It is characterized by high rainfall, most of which falls during the southwest monsoon. Protected areas include the Indira Gandhi and Periyar national parks.

Sri Lankan Moist Forest

Location Southwest Sri Lanka

Covering about 6,000 square miles (15,500 square km), this tropical and subtropical moist broadleaf forest is one of the world’s hotspots of endemism, with many animals and plants found nowhere else on

Earth. The nature of the forest changes with elevation. At lower levels, more than 300 tree species are known, with some individuals in protected areas such as Sinharaja Forest towering to 165 ft (50 m). The region is wet—with annual rainfall exceeding 197 in (5,000 mm) in places—conducive to the greatest diversity of amphibians on Earth.

The Sagano Bamboo Forest

Location Near Kyoto, the Japanese island of Honshu

Established by a monk in the 14th century, this forest now covers 6 square miles (16 square km). It is harvested regularly, but the bamboo regenerates rapidly, growing up to 80 ft (25 m) tall. A walk through this small area of *Phyllostachys* (moso) bamboo is an amazing experience aurally as well as visually as even the slightest breeze knocks the stems, or culms, together.

